

ART OF PREACHING (HONOR NOTES)



What Is Preaching?

Preaching is the act of communicating God's message to people through spoken words, with the purpose of teaching, encouraging, correcting, and leading listeners closer to God. It involves explaining the Bible clearly and applying it to daily life in a way people can understand and respond to.

Preaching is not just speaking; it is a spiritual ministry that combines biblical knowledge, clear communication, and a Christ-like life.

Purpose of Preaching

1. To share the Word of God faithfully.
2. To lead people to salvation through Jesus Christ.
3. To teach and explain biblical truths.
4. To encourage spiritual growth and obedience.
5. To correct error and warn against sin.
6. To inspire hope, faith, and love.

Qualities of a Good Preacher

1. Spiritual Life

Has a personal relationship with God.

Lives according to biblical principles.

Prays regularly for guidance and power.

2. Knowledge of the Bible

Understands Scripture correctly.

Studies the Bible carefully and prayerfully.

Uses the Bible as the main authority.

3. Clear Communication

Speaks clearly and confidently.

Uses simple and understandable language.

Organizes ideas logically.

4. Good Character

Is humble and teachable.

Shows love and respect to others.

Lives what they preach.

Types of Preaching

1. Expository Preaching

Explains a Bible passage verse by verse.

Focuses on the meaning of the text.

Example: Preaching from Psalm 23.

2. Topical Preaching

Focuses on a specific topic.

Uses several Bible texts to explain the topic.

Example: Faith, prayer, love, forgiveness.

3. Narrative Preaching

Uses Bible stories to teach lessons.

Makes the message relatable.

Example: David and Goliath.

4. Evangelistic Preaching

Aims to lead people to accept Christ.

Emphasizes repentance and salvation.

Steps in Preparing a Sermon

1. Prayer

Ask God for wisdom and guidance.

Pray for the audience.

2. Choose a Bible Text or Topic

Select a clear and relevant Scripture.

Ensure it fits the purpose of the message.

3. Study the Text

Read the passage carefully.

Understand the context and meaning.

Compare with other Bible verses.

4. Outline the Sermon

Introduction: Introduce the message.

Body: Main points with explanations.

Conclusion: Summary and appeal.

5. Application

Show how the message applies to daily life.

Encourage listeners to act on the message.

Parts of a Sermon

1. Introduction

Gains attention.

Introduces the topic.

Prepares listeners for the message.

2. Body

Contains main points.

Supported by Bible verses.

Includes explanations and illustrations.

3. Conclusion

Summarizes key ideas.

Makes a clear appeal or challenge.

Methods and Tools Used in Preaching

Bible (main tool)

Illustrations and examples

Stories and parables

Voice control and body language

Notes or sermon outline

Delivery of a Sermon

Voice

Speak clearly and at a good pace.

Use proper volume and tone.

Body Language

Maintain eye contact.

Use natural gestures.

Stand confidently.

Attitude

Be respectful and calm.

Show sincerity and passion.

Ethics of Preaching

Preach truthfully.

Do not misinterpret Scripture.

Avoid personal pride.

Give God all the glory.

Stewardship in Preaching

Stewardship in preaching means being faithful with the responsibility God has given.

Use time wisely during sermons.

Handle God's Word carefully.

Respect the audience.

Be accountable to God.

Importance of Preaching in the Church

Builds faith among believers.

Guides the church spiritually.

Strengthens unity.

Spreads the Gospel

Conclusion

The art of preaching is both a calling and a skill. It requires spiritual dedication, careful study of the Bible, and effective communication. A good preacher depends on God, prepares well, and delivers messages that transform lives.

What Is the Christian Art of Preaching?

Christian preaching is the Spirit-led communication of God's Word to people, with the purpose of teaching truth, calling for decision, and leading others to Christ.

1. Reasons / Benefits of Earning This Honor

Helps develop confidence in public speaking

Trains youth to correctly handle God's Word

Strengthens spiritual leadership skills

Prepares one for church and outreach ministry

Encourages personal Bible study and prayer

2. Homiletics (Definition)

Homiletics is the art and science of preparing and delivering sermons.

Sources:

Bible Dictionary

Christian preaching manuals

Theology textbooks

3. Exegesis (Definition)

Exegesis is the careful explanation and interpretation of a Bible text to discover its original meaning.

It includes:

Studying the context

Understanding the audience

Considering language and culture

4. Oratory

a. Definition of Oratory

Oratory is the skill of speaking clearly, confidently, and persuasively in public.

b. Brief History of Oratory

Biblical speakers: Moses, Isaiah, Jesus, Paul

Early Christian preachers spread the gospel by spoken word

Oratory has always been key in evangelism

5. Types of Sermons

a. Topical Sermon

Based on a topic supported by many Bible texts.

b. Expository Sermon

Explains a passage of Scripture verse by verse.

c. Textual Sermon

Built from one main Bible text.

6. Parts of a Sermon

1. Introduction – Grabs attention and introduces the theme
2. Body – Main points supported by Scripture
3. Illustration – Stories or examples that explain truth
4. Call – Appeal for response or decision
5. Conclusion – Summary and final encouragement

7. Bible Tools Used in Preaching

Biblical Dictionary – Explains Bible words and terms

Biblical Concordance – Finds verses by keywords

Thematic Study Bible – Groups texts by topics

Online Resources – Bibles, dictionaries, study aids

8. Bible Versions and Translations

Translation Types

Formal (Word-for-word) – Example: KJV, NASB

Dynamic (Thought-for-thought) – Example: NIV

Paraphrase – Example: The Message

Original Bible Languages

Old Testament: Hebrew and Aramaic

New Testament: Greek

9. Preparing a Sermon Outline

A good sermon outline includes:

Title

Main text

Theme

Introduction

Main points

Illustration

Call

Conclusion

10. Devotionals

A devotional is a short Bible message (5–10 minutes) that includes:

Scripture

Short explanation

Practical lesson

Prayer

11. Practical Preaching Experience

This honor requires:

Preaching sermons in church or public settings

Preparing written sermon outlines

Participating regularly in worship services

Key Christian Values in Preaching

Faithfulness to Scripture

Love for people

Dependence on the Holy Spirit

Humility and prayer

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